
EXPENSES TO PLAN FOR AFTER YOU RETIRE

1. **Housing.** Do you own your home, or do you rent? What area do you want to live in? Planning for retirement is very different in San Francisco or New York than it is in Missoula, Montana, or Lake Havasu, Arizona. You may be able to get a bigger place for less money or for less rent elsewhere.
 2. **Transportation.** How are you going to get around? Can you walk most places? Does a ride-sharing service exist in your city if you can no longer drive? If you have a car, you'll have to factor car payments (insurance, gas, maintenance) and possibly auto loan payments into what you'll need for retirement.
 3. **Food.** OBVIOUSLY. You'll still need to eat in retirement.
 4. **Health Care.** This can be hardest to plan ahead for. Colon cancer runs in my family. It's why my mom started getting colonoscopies waaay before the recommended time. So I know that colon cancer is something I should look out for. Does that mean I should put aside some extra money in case I get colon cancer? In an ideal world, sure. You never know what could happen to you as you age. Keeping that in mind when saving, while not being terrified of the inevitability of death, is a good idea. (Keeping it light over here.)
 5. **Entertainment.** On a happier note, you also need to save for having fun! You'll still want to go to the movies or buy records or attend museum exhibits or play virtual reality bridge or whatever other activities we'll all be doing when we retire. You need to be able to enjoy your life.
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